



Boston's hotel scene is almost as rich as its history, with properties ranging from hip, design-led boutiques to historical landmarks. Here are some suggestions:

Boston Harbour: The perfect hotel for those seeking a luxurious waterfront experience. Rooms from \$550 per night in summer

XV Beacon: A member of the Historic Hotels of America, it delivers a refined boutique hotel experience. Rooms from \$460 per night in summer

The Liberty: The former Boston prison is now a luxury hotel. Rooms from \$460 per night in summer

The Omni Parker House: Considered Boston's most haunted hotel, Charles Dickens' ghost is supposedly a resident. Rooms from \$280 per night in summer

Walk a bit further and you come across the site of the Boston Massacre where five civilians were killed in 1770, and then on to Old State House—the oldest surviving public building in Boston—happily standing between modern architecture and busy streets. A bit like Delhi, where you suddenly come across centuries old architecture serving as a roundabout.

A statue of Benjamin Franklin, Boston's leading patriot and son, marks the spot of the country's oldest public school. It's now a restaurant, again a bit like India, where heritage buildings often get converted into hotels.

The Freedom Trail leaves you wanting to discover more of the city's history and its role in the American Revolution. And the Boston Tea Party Ships and Museum is perfect for that. Here, actors deliver fiery speeches, visitors toss replica tea crates into the water, and everyone gets caught up in the moment. It's a great way to make history feel alive without turning it into a lecture.

Boston is a city of firsts. Little wonder, the oldest continually operating restaurant in the US, the Union Oyster House, is here. It's all dark wood and old-school charm. JFK used to have lunch there, and yes, they still have his booth. I felt mildly smug sitting there with a bowl of clam chowder, the same thing a young senator once slurped down before he became, well, JFK.

Of course, no trip to Boston is complete without crossing the Charles River to Cambridge. Harvard Yard is exactly what you imagine: brick buildings, leafy paths (prettier in the fall) and students with higher IQs than most. I joined a student-led tour that was full of gossip, university myths, and anecdotes about famous alumni.

Art is another thing Boston does surprisingly well. The Harvard Art Museums has self-portraits by both Van Gogh and Renoir, along with several Picassos. The Museum of Fine Arts is huge and has a genuinely impressive collection of Indian art, which caught me off-guard. And down by the waterfront, the Institute of Contemporary Art adds a whole other layer to the city: minimalist glass with bold exhibits.

By the end of my trip, I realised Boston never tries too hard. It doesn't need to. The charm is quiet, the history constant, the food excellent, the vibe warm and easy-going. And maybe that's why the city stays with you long after you have left... **BT**

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